



Western states

BIRTHPLACE OF SUCH POWERFUL

American icons as the cowboy and the movie star, the Western region of the US also contains some of the most breathtaking landscapes in the world: the Rocky Mountains, the Grand Canyon, the Death Valley desert, and the stunning national parks of Yellowstone and Yosemite.



MOVIE CITY

Gwyneth Paltrow poses for photographers at Hollywood's annual Academy Award ceremony. California's film industry has spread the influence of American culture to almost every corner of the world.



WATER WONDERLAND

California's climate and location make it ideal for water sports. Windsurfing was invented here in 1968 when two friends—a surfer and a sailor—decided to combine their passions.



WINTER SCENE

Colorado is North America's premier destination for skiers. Famous for its celebrity visitors and residents, the pretty resort of Aspen (shown here) is totally surrounded by mountains.

LAS VEGAS

The extravagant glamour of Las Vegas has made this Nevada city one of the world's gambling meccas. Here, fabulous hotels offer 24-hour gaming in opulent casinos where drinks are always on tap, and where there are no windows or clocks to remind players of the outside world.



WEST COAST METROPOLIS

San Francisco is built on rugged terrain that dominates its landscape. The cable car was designed in 1873 by Scots-born Andrew Hallidie to replace the carriage-pulling horses that were often injured on the treacherous slopes.

